

The Washington Post

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SU V1 V2 V3 V4

Entertainment group circles D.C. area for new ‘mini-Sphere’

BY ERIN COX, TRAVIS M. ANDREWS AND ETHAN BECK

Sphere Entertainment Co. built the largest spherical building on Earth in Las Vegas.

Now it wants to build a smaller one outside D.C.

The company behind Sphere unveiled plans Sunday night for what it says will be the world's

Immersive venue at National Harbor would echo one in Las Vegas

first “mini-Sphere” venue off the Potomac River in Maryland, a 6,000-seat immersive experience that would open in 2030.

The smaller cousin of the famed Vegas attraction would offer the same features as the original.

It would be about a third of the size, but would cost half as much to build — more than \$1 billion, situated near an existing casino at National Harbor. With its 4D experience, the venue is expected to generate \$1 billion in economic activity annually by hosting

large-scale, immersive concerts with in-residence artists, sporting events, other shows and corporate functions.

“This Sphere in National Harbor, it will have all the elements that we have in Las Vegas,” David “Digger” Granville-Smith, Sphere Entertainment Co.’s executive vice president, said in an interview.

As he described it, the mini-Sphere would have sight lines to

the Washington Monument, making it visible on flight paths to Reagan National Airport — its domed, LED-paneled exterior sparkling with ads and art installations on its “Exosphere.”

That is, if it all goes as planned. The deal includes about \$200 million in incentives Maryland governments and a private company offered — mostly public

SEE SPHERE ON A8

Trump stokes E.U. ire via text

TIES GREENLAND BID TO NOBEL REJECTION

Message to Norway’s leader triggers pushback

BY ELLEN FRANCIS AND STEVE HENDRIX

BRUSSELS — In a message to Norway’s prime minister, President Donald Trump linked his insistence on taking over Greenland to his grievance over not receiving the Nobel Peace Prize — adding a new twist to Trump’s stoking of a trade war that is shaking the transatlantic alliance.

In the weekend text to Norwegian Prime Minister Jonas Gahr Store, Trump wrote that he no longer needed to “think purely of Peace” after he didn’t win the peace prize last year — an award that the president has openly coveted and is bestowed by the Nobel Committee in Norway.

Trump then questioned the “ownership” of Greenland by Denmark, a NATO ally, and repeated his ambition for the United States to take “complete and total control” of the autonomous Danish territory.

In a statement, White House spokeswoman Anna Kelly said that Trump “believes Greenland

SEE EUROPE ON A12

WorldView: At Davos, a conflict with the forum’s paradigms. A12

Big Tech billionaires spur exodus from Calif.

Some of state’s richest are relocating as industry rails against proposed tax

BY ELIZABETH DWOSKIN AND CAROLINE O’DONOVAN

In late December, White House official and tech investor David Sacks made a cryptic post on X: “Message received,” he wrote, above a photo of anti-billionaire demonstrators gathered in front of his San Francisco mansion.

The post made public what Sacks and other billionaires had been planning privately: They were plotting to leave California in protest of a proposed wealth tax that would affect the state’s richest residents.

Anger at the proposal, which would levy a one-time 5 percent tax on the assets of California residents worth more than a billion dollars, had simmered in group chats and at holiday parties since the provision was announced in November. “It was all anyone was talking about,” said Mike Solana, chief marketing officer of billionaire Peter Thiel’s Founders Fund, who has written about the tax on his right-leaning

SEE BILLIONAIRES ON A17

In Iran, a feeling of betrayal by Trump

Some protesters say they were encouraged by his promise to intervene

BY YEGANEH TORBATI AND SOUAD MEKHENNET

ISTANBUL — Reeling from a crackdown on protesters in Iran that left thousands dead, Iranians are now grappling with feelings of betrayal, confusion and uncertainty after President Donald Trump repeatedly promised to intervene on their behalf and then declined to do so.

Some Iranians said in interviews that Trump’s words of support had added to their determination to resist the Iranian government after protests erupted initially over dire economic conditions and then took on widespread demands for ousting the entire ruling system.

Hadis, 36, a Tehran resident, said in an interview that Iranians turned out to protest, despite widespread killings by security forces, with expectations that Trump would order a military strike on Iranian targets. “Our eyes were fixed on the sky, like something will happen. He’ll hit now,” Hadis said. “We came out [to protest] with fear, but we had hope that Trump will strike now, will kill these guys.”

After Trump refrained from launching an attack, she concluded that he did not have Iranians’ interests in mind. “Trump isn’t

SEE IRAN ON A14

High-speed train collision in Spain kills at least 39



SUSANA VERA/REUTERS

Emergency personnel work Monday at the site of a collision late Sunday between two high-speed trains near Adamuz in southern Spain. The crash occurred after a Madrid-bound train partially derailed, causing it to collide with a second train traveling in the opposite direction. At least 39 people were killed and 73 were injured, officials said. **Story, A13**

Protest at Miller’s house lands neighbor under investigation

BY OLIVIA GEORGE

She was kneeling in her front yard, pulling weeds from around a peach tree, when the police and federal agents arrived. Four men, she remembers, with a question. “Are you Barbara Wien?”

By that balmy afternoon in early October, she sensed that her protest campaign against one of

President Donald Trump’s most powerful aides might stir trouble. A few weeks prior, she’d seen two strangers lingering outside her Arlington home. Law enforcement, she had surmised. Shaken, she spent a couple of nights in a neighbor’s basement.

Now, members of the FBI, Secret Service and Virginia State Police approached. They demand-

ed her phone, saying it could contain evidence of criminal conduct.

Wien, a 66-year-old retired peace studies professor, took off her gardening gloves and read the search warrant, signed by a judge after police accused her of a “coordinated plan to intimidate and harass Stephen Miller.” Trump’s deputy chief of staff for policy and architect of the immigration agen-

da that angered Wien so much. Investigators had seen a message in a group chat where Wien vowed to make “his life hell.”

There on her lawn, she learned that she was under criminal investigation for what she saw as taking a stand against the administration’s policies; that her lifelong commitment to political activism

SEE NEIGHBOR ON A4

VALENTINO GARAVANI 1932-2026

Fashion icon dressed the famous with Italian flair

BY ETHAN BECK

Valentino Garavani, the mononymously known Italian couturier who dressed people of status from Hollywood and royalty, died Monday at his house in Rome. He was 93.

His death was confirmed in a statement by the Fondazione Valentino Garavani e Giancarlo Giammetti.

Mr. Garavani opened Valentino in Rome in 1960, with the backing of his father. From then until 2008, he was its creative director, defining Italian style with his signature color (red) and details (such as bows and embroidery) while avoiding trends and self-important artistry.



Mr. Garavani

He remained in the public eye by crafting pieces for celebrities, such as Jacqueline Kennedy, Elizabeth Taylor, Cate Blanchett, Princess Diana and Julia Roberts, while maintaining friendships with an endless number of them.

“As a creator, beauty is the most important,” Mr. Garavani said in a 2011 interview with the Talks. “Since I was a child I loved the way a dress looks, I admired a great face, a lovely body. I enjoy the beauty in a woman, in a man, in a child, in a painting.”

Along with his business partner, Giancarlo Giammetti, Mr. Garavani helped Italian fashion connect with Paris, setting the

SEE VALENTINO ON A20



DEMETRIUS FREEMAN/THE WASHINGTON POST

An annual remembrance

The Friendship Woodridge Public Charter School band marches in D.C. in the local Martin Luther King Jr. Peace Day parade; events took place in many parts of the country. **Coverage, A9, B12**

IN THE NEWS

Spanberger’s address Virginia’s governor sharpened her vision, which includes a focus on health care, housing and energy. **B12**

Vaccination schedule Some pediatricians say they are essentially ignoring the Trump administration’s overhaul of the list of routine immunizations recommended for children. **A3**

THE NATION The Justice Department said it would probe an anti-ICE protest at a Minnesota church. **A6**

In a return to podcasting after leaving the FBI, Dan Bongino faces fans who feel “conned.” **A8**

THE WORLD Ukraine’s solidified control of Kupiansk is denying Russia a key bargaining chip. **A11**

A trial opened in Prince Harry’s case alleging illegal acts by the Daily Mail. **A15**

THE ECONOMY A cap on credit card rates proposed by the president might benefit some consumers — and have unintended consequences for others. **A16**

Backyards are shrinking as homeowners, locked into low mortgage rates, build out instead of moving. **A17**

STYLE Changes at the Kennedy Center highlight its leaders’ misunderstanding of the arts, writes critic Michael Andor Brodeur. **B1**

SPORTS In the NFL playoffs, the next crop of star quarterbacks is showing what it’s capable of. **B7**

THE REGION Mayor hopeful Kenyan R. McDuffie is likely to be replaced on the D.C. Council by Doni Crawford, one of his staffers. **B12**

At the annual Rev. Martin Luther King Jr. peace walk in D.C., attendees marched with a renewed sense of urgency. **B12**

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